

THE TYCOON TIMES

ANALYSE | DECIDE | LEAD

THE BLOOPINGHAM BULLETIN

INDUSTRY LEADERS VANISH AS STOLEN THE TIME MACHINE ACTIVATES

**Emergency summit at
the Off White House
ends in a blinding flash**



BLOOPINGHAM, DIVIDED STATES OF FREEDOM —Industry leaders gathered at the Off White House to assess the Yapton Port heist and its damage to global supply chains. One question overshadowed the meeting: why had thieves targeted small shipments, ignored larger valuables, and left mistakes that practically guided investigators to them? Was the heist a distraction? Elongated Muskmelon revealed that one specifically targeted container remained missing. Asked what it held, he answered: “Classified.” “I have the data,” interrupted The Zucc, who had accessed Muskmelon’s private Kilogram chats. The messages described an extraordinary machine, while leaked ClosedAI conversations confirmed AI-assisted development and a working prototype. Before Zucc could explain further, the President cut his microphone. “NO MORE.” Heavy footsteps approached. A hooded figure entered carrying the missing machine. “And who are you, buddy?” demanded Yensen Wang, founder of MVideo. “What matters is that I have Muskmelon’s machine,” the stranger replied. “It is... a time machine.” Wang recognised him: **John Burglar**. The hood dropped. The machine powered up. “NO! IT IS NOT READY!” shouted Muskmelon. A blinding flash emptied the room. Every leader vanished. The machine’s final display showed a date decades in the past and a destination marked **LOCATION: UNKNOWN**. The world had lost its most powerful industry leaders. They had gained a chance to change history.

STRANDED IN THE COLD WAR

Leaders separate to build new lives while Muskmelon searches for a way home

Zucc awoke in a dense forest and roused the scattered leaders. Andrew Nugget demanded to know where they were; Muskmelon confirmed time travel but could not identify the year. Wang approached two woodcutters, who offered to guide them out. Unable to give the year, the men described hostility between America and the Soviet Union, exhausting work and poor wages. “Muskmelon, we’re stuck in the Cold War,” Wang told the group. Muskmelon admitted that the unfinished machine offered no known route home. Until he found a solution, they would have to pass as locals, separate and communicate only through letters. Following the woodcutters out, the leaders adapted their accents and mannerisms and each established a company. Muskmelon alone stayed focused on getting them back to the future.



MYSTERY PROFESSOR REVOLUTIONISES EDUCATION

An unknown professor stunned the country with apparently unwritten examination questions that his students somehow answered perfectly. Within weeks, his school topped national results, applications surged, and rivals failed to copy his methods.

The “professor” was future education leader Andrew Nugget. Using advanced teaching methods, psychology and examination patterns, he rebuilt the system. Within a year, schools nationwide adopted his textbooks and examinations. Rival leaders resisted—then enrolled their own children.

APPLICATION BOOM TURNS ADMISSIONS INTO BIG BUSINESS

Nugget’s flawless testing metrics triggered overwhelming demand for academy places. Admissions offices became among the empire’s most profitable—and heavily guarded—operations.

TEACHER DISMISSALS DRIVE UP RETRAINING COSTS

Traditional educators struggled to grasp Nugget’s methods. Thousands were dismissed, forcing him to spend heavily on training a replacement generation of instructors.



HIGHWAY TOLLS DRAIN SCHOOL TRANSPORT BUDGETS

Moving textbooks and school buses remains Nugget’s crippling bottleneck. Moses-Lawless’s highway cartels impose exorbitant tolls, draining school logistics budgets at every intersection.

CURRICULUM RIGHTS BECOME EDUCATION’S TOP INVESTMENT

Nugget introduced cognitive behavioural approaches and spaced repetition unfamiliar to local classrooms. His proprietary textbooks displaced existing curricula, prompting Wall Street to identify exclusive curriculum and content rights as the sector’s most lucrative investment.



NUGGET CONTROLS THE CERTIFICATION GATEWAY

By securing exclusive control over standardised testing patterns, Nugget made his examinations the route to universally recognised qualifications. Students seeking certification had no choice but to pay his fees.

RIVALS PROVIDE FREE ADVERTISING

Nugget spent nothing on advertising. When competing education leaders quietly enrolled their own children, word spread faster than any paid campaign could have managed.

“SMART BOX” MAKER TAKES CONTROL OF ELECTRONICS

Unknown manufacturer Jonathan Monterio became the country's largest electronics supplier after unveiling the “Smart Box.” Though its purpose initially baffled observers, it could calculate, store information and communicate with other devices—astonishing capabilities for the era.

Rivals failed to reverse-engineer it. Monterio offered access on one condition: all manufacturing must pass through his company. Within months, major manufacturers depended on his patents, placing the industry under his technological control.

SMART BOXES RUN DANGEROUSLY HOT

Without modern polymers or advanced cooling alloys, powerful Smart Boxes overheat inside heavy steel and aluminium casings. Available materials and thermal systems are struggling to support Monterio's technology.

ADVERTISING CUT AS CUSTOMERS QUEUE IN THE RAIN

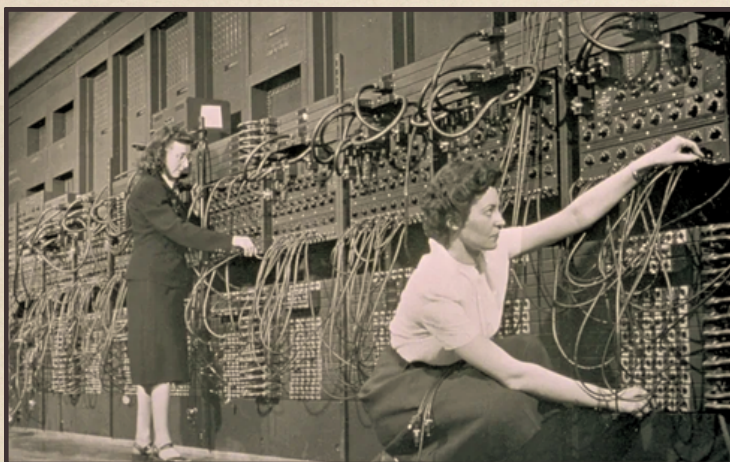
Monterio slashed traditional marketing budgets, infuriating Madison Avenue. With exclusive control over the world's most advanced computer, he lets queues of rain-soaked customers do the selling.

CARTEL TOLLS CONSUME SHIPPING PROFITS

Moving finished devices remains Monterio's weakness. Highway cartels controlling the Interstate Bypass Network extract millions in tollway charges simply to get Smart Boxes out of factories and into shops.

MYSTERY CHIPS TRIGGER INVESTMENT FRENZY

Under 1963 microscopes, the Smart Box's intricate chips appeared to be smooth metal, leading bewildered scientists to suspect alien technology. Established engineers suddenly lacked relevant expertise. Investors anticipated the century's highest returns from securing semiconductor and chip rights.



OLD FACTORIES ASSEMBLE NEW BOXES

Vacuum-tube television factories became contract assembly lines for Monterio. Meanwhile, demand for traditional analogue components collapsed, driving their manufacturers into bankruptcy.



PATENT FLOOD BLOCKS RIVAL MEMORY RESEARCH

Monterio submitted thousands of future designs for solid-state memory and digital storage to the US Patent Office. His sweeping claims effectively locked competing researchers out for the next fifty years.

PRODUCTION PATENTS MAKE MANUFACTURING THE TOP ASSET

Drawing research from future textbooks, Hicks secured sweeping patents over chemical production processes. Competitors were forced to rent manufacturing capacity from him, making his drug-manufacturing monopoly the medical sector's highest-yielding asset

HOSPITAL REVENUES SURGE AS TRIALS ARE BYPASSED

Claiming prior knowledge of his medicines' safety, Hicks bypassed lengthy clinical trials. Hospitals adopting the treatments reported recovery times falling from months to days and a sharp rise in facility revenues.

PATIENT DEMAND REPLACES PHARMACEUTICAL SALES TEAMS

Lli Eily effectively dismissed its marketing department. With patients demanding medicines that produced extraordinary recoveries, Hicks saw little need for travelling sales representatives.

HIGHWAY EXTORTION THREATENS MEDICINE DELIVERIES

Temperature-sensitive vials must cross highways controlled by Moses-Lawless. Crippling cartel tolls inflate distribution costs, leaving delivery trucks as Hicks's principal vulnerability.

FAILED COPIES CEMENT HICKS'S QUALITY ADVANTAGE

Competitors blindly reproducing Hicks's formulas produced toxic batches that failed contemporary FDA standards. Their failures reinforced Lli Eily's position as the country's only trusted safe supplier.



LLI EILY FOUNDER CORNERS MEDICINE MARKET

Multimillionaire Ravid Hicks, founder of Lli Eily, stunned sceptical doctors with futuristic medicines. Patients recovered rapidly, while diseases including polio and rabies gained reliable treatments.

Rivals attempting to reproduce the drugs discovered that Hicks had patented their production processes as well as the medicines. Forced to purchase his ingredients, technology and licences, they became dependent on him. Within two years, most national medicine supplies came from his company.

His explanation? "I read a lot." His source was modern pharmaceutical textbooks—many of which he had also authored.

SCEPTICAL DOCTORS AND OLD EQUIPMENT HINDER TREATMENT

Physicians resisted results they could not explain, while glass syringes and outdated medical devices complicated treatment. Hicks's futuristic medicines faced stubborn limits in both staff acceptance and available equipment.



HAMSEY BUILDS FOOD EMPIRE THROUGH ESPIONAGE

Restaurant magnate Gordon Hamsey seized the national food supply chain through sabotage, scandals and bargain-price takeovers.

His double agent, James Burger—a tuxedo-clad, martini-drinking spy equipped with salt-shaker cameras and exploding pens—infiltrated rivals and replaced secret seasoning formulas with excessive cayenne.

Photographed files from agricultural executives' safes then appeared in newspapers, exposing price-fixing, health-code bribery and illicit affairs. As public trust collapsed, Hamsey bought the damaged companies for pennies on the dollar.

Blackmail, rigged congressional caucuses and telephone taps made with telegraph wire helped dismantle farming unions and secure his monopoly in under six months.

Questioned by Congress, Hamsey replied: "People don't care who controls the seeds, as long as the bread is cheap."

FARMS AND SEED VAULTS BECOME FOOD'S INVESTMENT TOP

Cheap hostile buyouts gave Hamsey control of major farms, seed vaults and processing plants before authorities reacted. His raw-ingredient procurement monopoly became the industry's most profitable investment.



HIGHWAY TOLLS WIPE OUT FOOD DELIVERY MARGINS

Robert Moses-Lawless's cartels control the Interstate Bypass Network. Their extortionate tolls consume the margins on cross-state deliveries of perishable food, threatening Hamsey's otherwise dominant empire.

PRICE CONTROL REPLACES CULINARY RESEARCH

Hamsey eliminated culinary R&D budgets, favouring aggressive price-fixing and predatory revenue management.

Controlling prices proved more profitable than developing new recipes.

FOOD SAFETY TURNED INTO SABOTAGE WEAPON

Double agents compromised rival quality-control operations by adding excessive cayenne to products. Customers fled in tears, turning food safety into another instrument of corporate warfare.

FARMING UNIONS DISMANTLED THROUGH BLACKMAIL

Rigged political proceedings and blackmail broke farming unions nationwide. Workers lost their protections, leaving Hamsey with a demoralised and increasingly volatile agricultural workforce.

CAMERAS AND WIRETAPS REPLACE ADVERTISING

Traditional marketing was abandoned. Hamsey instead used surveillance technology to expose rivals' health-code bribes in the press, destroying their sales overnight.

OTHER INDUSTRIES' TOLL LOSSES BECOME CARTEL PROFITS

While other sectors struggle with freight costs, the syndicate's logistics operations collect the charges. Toll payments from food, medicine, electronics and textbook deliveries have made its transport wings enormously wealthy.

MARKETING FUNDS DIVERTED TO POLITICAL BRIBES

With competing travel options eliminated, the syndicate sees little need for advertising or better vehicle technology. Marketing budgets have instead become slush funds for bribing city councillors



DEALERSHIPS BOOM AS TOURISM IS DESTROYED

Demolished historic districts devastated local tourism. Meanwhile, highway exits forced traffic towards syndicate-owned dealerships and overpriced parking garages, making dealership and distribution operations transport's highest-returning investment.

TRANSIT DESTRUCTION FUELS CAR AND PETROLEUM DEMAND

With public transport eliminated, commuters became dependent on Ford-Fiesta II and Leclerc's factories. Inefficient luxury sedans filled the roads, locking in increased vehicle sales and petroleum demand.

HIGHWAY SYNDICATE SEIZES STATE TRANSPORT NETWORK

Municipal commissioner Robert Moses-Lawless, Henry Ford-Fiesta II and Enzo Leclerc have taken control of state transport through the Interstate Bypass Network. Historic neighbourhoods were bulldozed for six-lane tollways. Mechanics sabotaged public transit with sugar in fuel tanks and severed trolley lines, while councillors received luxury sedans as bribes.

Secret land trusts bought cheap farmland along planned routes and resold it to highway cartels at enormous markups. Exits funnelled drivers into syndicate-owned parking garages. Operators refusing to sell found depot roads turned into dead ends or blocked by bridge works.

Asked about missing funds at a senate inquiry, Moses-Lawless declared: "As long as the asphalt keeps rolling, the city moves forward."

By the time investigators intervened, trolley tracks lay beneath three feet of concrete. Every commute generated toll income, while city hall drawers held incriminating blueprints, zoning payoffs and hush-money ledgers.

AUTOMOTIVE RESEARCH EFFECTIVELY SHUT DOWN

The syndicate has effectively outlawed automotive R&D. Funding better transport has given way to bribing zoning boards and building profitable highways through cheap land.

RAIL WORKERS DISMISSED AS MECHANICS BECOME SABOTEURS

Thousands of trolley operators and rail engineers are unemployed. Auto mechanics, meanwhile, are being recruited to sabotage competitors rather than maintain vehicles.